

YILAN ANNIE GAO

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PMP · CSM · M.Ed. · M.P.I.

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

- 12 years of program and operations leadership driving complex, cross-functional initiatives in fast-paced global technology environments — from platform-scale live events to regulatory compliance programs.
- Proven track record owning end-to-end project lifecycles — maintaining master calendars, managing work-back schedules, anticipating blockers, and aligning diverse stakeholders toward shared outcomes.
- Experienced supporting VP- and C-suite decision-making through structured data synthesis, executive reporting frameworks, and clear strategic narratives across Engineering, Policy, Legal, and Business functions.
- PMP and CSM certified; bilingual English and Mandarin with deep multi-regional program management experience spanning US, China, Japan, and Latin America.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Program Manager, Developer Relations | Roblox Corporation | San Mateo, CA *Feb 2023 – Present*

Strategic Operations & Cross-Functional Program Management (2025–Present)

- Serve as primary cross-functional POC across Engineering, Policy, Legal, and Moderation — driving alignment on shared goals, timelines, and deliverables for Roblox's Top 1,000 creator accounts.
- Own complex project timelines, escalation workflows, and communication strategy across 4+ global functions; represent developer impact in VP and C-suite meetings to align on strategic response.
- Built Roblox's first false-moderation protection system from the ground up — defining process, escalation paths, and cross-functional communication across Safety, Policy, and Legal teams.
- Drove GTM strategy and end-to-end rollout of an IP protection product despite low internal prioritization, onboarding the platform's top 15 developer teams through phased launch management and continuous feedback loops.
- Manage 3 direct reports and mentor interns; synthesized 600+ support tickets into actionable insights informing resource planning and process improvements.

LiveOps — Event Production & Project Management (2024)

- Project-managed 5 platform-wide live events each reaching 10M+ players, overseeing full lifecycle from planning through live execution — managing vendors, tracking real-time risks, and ensuring on-time delivery in a high-velocity environment.
- Maintained master project calendar, work-back schedules, and executive reporting; translated real-time and post-event analytics into strategic recommendations for subsequent events.

International Expansion & Creator Operations (2023)

- Coordinated multi-stakeholder programs across China, Japan, and Latin America; co-designed a structured developer feedback system embedding global developer insights into the product development cycle upstream.

Senior Program Manager, Developer Relations | Roblox China | Shenzhen, China *Mar 2021 – Feb 2023*

- Strategy and operations partner reporting to VP of DevRel China; orchestrated cross-functional communications aligning China market priorities with Global HQ product and business strategies across time zones.
- Designed and delivered high-stakes executive narratives — synthesizing market performance, developer trends, and operational data into decision-ready briefings that influenced Global HQ investment and resource allocation.
- Defined GTM strategy for platform launch and built executive reporting frameworks to track post-launch performance; led negotiation with US Finance team to establish China's data access framework.
- Structured ambiguous local developer and compliance needs into prioritized recommendations for global engineering teams, ensuring China market requirements were represented in cross-functional planning cycles.

Partnership Programs Lead | California State University, San Bernardino | San Bernardino, CA *Apr 2019 – Apr 2021*

- Managed a portfolio of institutional partnerships achieving 60% recruitment growth in year one and 100% program renewal rate through proactive relationship management.
- Designed and delivered 4 recurring end-to-end programs totaling 130+ instructional hours; managed budgets exceeding \$4M USD; led cross-functional design initiatives resulting in 23% improvement in engagement.

China Programs Coordinator | Virginia Commonwealth University | Richmond, VA *Jul 2014 – Mar 2019*

- Led international recruitment strategy achieving 300% enrollment growth; developed and managed 5 signature international education programs coordinating 10+ campus departments and 20+ partner institutions.

CERTIFICATIONS & SKILLS

Project Management: PMP (PMI) · Certified Scrum Master (CSM) · Agile · Scrum · Kanban · Waterfall

Strategy & Operations: Cross-functional Leadership · GTM Strategy · Executive Communication · Stakeholder Alignment · Process Optimization · Risk Management

Tools: Jira · Confluence · Tableau · SQL · Excel (advanced) · Google Suite · Flourish · Data Visualization

Languages: English (native) · Mandarin Chinese (native)

AI Tools: Claude · ChatGPT · Gemini — actively applied to workflow automation and operational efficiency

EDUCATION

Master of Product Innovation — Virginia Commonwealth University *Dec 2018*

Master of Education — Adult Learning & HRD — Virginia Commonwealth University *May 2014*

Bachelor of Arts — English & International Relations — Sichuan International Studies University *Jul 2012*